
Appendix

*MSc Cyber Security at NIBM: proposal to the University of Essex.
Held for questions, not presented.*

- A1 Essex Online versus the franchise
- A2 Partnerships, and the choice of Essex
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A1 Essex Online versus the franchise

University of Essex Online

- Wholly online, self-directed, 15 to 20 hours a week per module
- International fee GBP 13,049, about LKR 5.9 million at LKR 450 per pound
- BCS accredited; multiple starts a year
- Buyer: the disciplined remote learner who can fund a UK fee

Essex award franchised to NIBM

- In-country cohort, supervised labs, employer-reviewed capstone
- Locally priced against a LKR 0.35 to 0.78 million field
- Evening and weekend timetable built for Sri Lankan working hours
- Buyer: the graduate or professional who cannot reach the online fee and will not buy purely online study

Survey evidence: 84% likely or very likely with a UK award at an untested price; 40% would need a loan or scholarship; entry-level IT pay near LKR 80,000 a month makes the online fee about six years of salary. The franchise adds a segment; it does not move one.

A2 Partnerships, and the choice of Essex

How NIBM chooses partners

- One partner per specialism, chosen on strength in that award
- Coventry University: undergraduate computing partner since 2017; that relationship continues unchanged
- University College Dublin (1996), Griffith transfer pathway, Ural Federal, Limkokwing: each for a specific purpose
- Postgraduate cyber is a level no current arrangement covers: this adds a partner at that level, it replaces none

Why Essex on the evidence

- Highest-ranked UK awarding university among those delivered in Colombo: CUG 29, Guardian 12 (2026)
- 6th in the UK for research power in computer science (REF 2021, THE measure)
- Programme profile continues the Ethical Hacking and Network Security stream: security by design, digital identity, forensics, network security
- The PgDip exit and PgCert already exist in Essex's own award portfolio
- Essex's TNE strategy names Sri Lanka as a priority market

A3 NCSC certification: what may be claimed

Route delivered in Sri Lanka	UK awarding programme	NCSC status (list of May 2026)	Expiry
NIBM (proposed)	Essex MSc Cyber Security	Provisionally certified	30 Sep 2027
IIT	Westminster MSc Cyber Security and Forensics	Fully certified	30 Sep 2028
ESOFT	Kingston MSc Network and Information Security (cyber pathway)	Fully certified	30 Sep 2026
UCL Sri Lanka	Lancashire MSc Cyber Security	Not listed (a different Lancashire programme is)	n/a
APIIT	Staffordshire MSc Cyber Security	Not listed	n/a
NEXT Campus (unverified)	London Metropolitan MSc Cyber Security	Not listed	n/a

Certification attaches to the programme as delivered and assessed by the named UK academic team. Whether it extends to a franchised delivery is Essex's to answer; NIBM will claim nothing locally until Essex confirms what may be said. Essex Online's MSc is BCS accredited, not NCSC listed.

A4 The local field and the fee band

Provider	Award	Model	Published fee (LKR)	Mode
UCL Sri Lanka	Lancashire MSc Cyber Security	UK award, local delivery	325,000 + GBP 1,000 (about 775,000)	12 months, on campus; launched Feb 2026
IIT	Westminster MSc Cyber Security and Forensics	UK award, local delivery	Not published	Part time, 2 years
ESOFT	Kingston MSc Network and Information Security	UK award, local delivery	350,000 (stale listing)	Listed full time
APIIT	Staffordshire MSc Cyber Security	UK award, local delivery	Not published	Not published
SLIIT	MSc IT (Cyber Security)	Own Sri Lankan award	550,000 (stale listing)	Part time, 2 years
UCSC	Master of Cybersecurity	State university award	615,000	2 yrs part time, evenings and Sat; 2023 intake 28

Source: NIBM competitor matrix, 12 Sep 2026, GBP component restated at LKR 450. Two further UK-partner routes (NEXT Campus, ANC) are unverified. Four of six UK-partner routes publish no fee. Almost all provision is part time, evenings and weekends.

A5 Survey method, weighting and limitations

Survey A: students, n = 57

- Microsoft Forms, 6 items, anonymous; open link circulated within NIBM, 22 to 24 Sep 2026
- 49 current undergraduates (86%), 8 graduates; no population denominator, so no response rate
- Committed demand = positive on a UK award and start within 12 months, then weighted 0.8 / 0.3 (central) or 0.6 / 0.2 (conservative) on the top two bands
- Limits: self-selected, no fee question, UK question asked after the NIBM question (possible ordering effect), timing aspirational for undergraduates

Survey B: industry and academics, n = 7

- Microsoft Forms, 9 items, named; purposive sample of senior people already engaged with NIBM, none NIBM staff
- IT services, telecom, insurance and its regulator, three national-university academics
- Qualitative evidence: quoted by sector only, because the form did not capture attribution consent
- Limits: n = 7; willingness to contribute captured as yes or no, so mode of contribution and teaching capacity were followed up directly

A6 Verification status

Item	Status	Owner
Whether NCSC certification extends to a franchised delivery	Open: ask Essex	Partnerships team
Essex's expected commercial terms and any fee floor	Open: ask Essex	Partnerships team
NIBM's regulatory standing to host a foreign master's award	Open: registrar, Coventry documentation	Partnerships team
Fee-band question to the student population	Planned: one day	Academic delivery
Delivery panel titles, CVs and consent to be named	Verified from public sources; consent in progress	Academic delivery
League tables refreshed to 2027 editions	Before the meeting	Academic delivery
Competitor fees for IIT, ESOF, SLIIT by direct enquiry	Open	Academic delivery
Regulatory recognition of the award in Sri Lanka	To confirm	Partnerships team